

Importing modules

Before using a module, you have to tell the computer to import it so it can be used by your program. This allows the bits of code it contains to be available to you. Importing modules is done using the “import” command. Python can import modules in a few different ways.

```
import random
```

```
random.randint(1, 6)
random.choice(my_list)
```

The module name comes before each function

▷ “from random import *”

Importing a module like this works well for small programs. But it can get confusing with bigger programs because it isn’t clear which module the function belongs to.

```
from random import *
```

Imports all the functions from the Random module

```
randint(1, 6)
choice(my_list)
```

This code doesn’t show which module the function came from

Imports only the “randint” function

```
from random import randint
```

```
randint(1, 6)
```

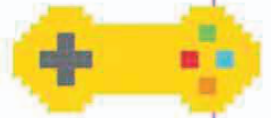
Only the “randint” function is available



EXPERT TIPS

Pygame

Pygame is a Python library designed for writing video games. Pygame gives you access to sound modules and special graphics that can be used in games. You’ll be able to use Pygame once you have a good understanding of the basics of Python covered in this book.



Help and documentation

Not sure how to use a module or what functions are available? The Python Library Reference has all the details. Simply click on the library you want to learn more about. It’s a good idea to get to know the libraries, modules, and functions that are available, so you don’t waste time writing code that already exists.

Help

About IDLE

IDLE Help

Python Docs



◁ Help!

At the top of any IDLE window, click “Help” and choose “Python Docs”. This brings up a window with lots of useful information.